

To the Commissioners:

I appreciate the opportunity to comment on the SEC's proposed amendments related to optional semiannual reporting.

As a finance and governance executive with experience in public-company reporting, IPO readiness, SOX/internal controls, Audit Committee engagement, and operational finance leadership, I believe the proposal raises important considerations around balancing regulatory burden, investor transparency, and long-term value creation.

I support the Commission's effort to provide flexibility in reporting cadence rather than mandating a single reporting structure for all issuers. Public companies operate with very different business models, investor bases, operational cycles, and resource constraints, and a more principles-based framework may better align reporting obligations with company-specific circumstances.

From an operational perspective, quarterly reporting can create significant organizational burden beyond the direct filing process itself. Management attention, finance resources, auditor coordination, and board governance activities often become heavily concentrated around quarterly cycles. In some organizations, this cadence can unintentionally reinforce short-term decision-making and near-term performance management at the expense of longer-term strategic execution and investment.

At the same time, I do not believe the conversation should simply be framed as "less reporting." Financial statements are inherently backward-looking, and reducing reporting frequency may further widen the information gap between institutional and non-institutional investors.

Large institutional investors often have greater access to management teams, industry data, research resources, and alternative information channels outside of standardized SEC reporting. By contrast, many retail and non-institutional investors rely more heavily on periodic SEC disclosures as a primary source of transparent, comparable, and decision-useful information.

For that reason, quarterly reporting serves an important governance and market-discipline function beyond simply communicating financial results. It creates regular accountability, standardized disclosure cadence, and broader market transparency that may be more difficult to replicate through voluntary or less structured communications.

One area I believe deserves particular consideration is the increasing importance of enterprise risk integration and governance visibility. Boards today are overseeing

significantly more interconnected operational, technology, cybersecurity, AI, compliance, workforce, and financial risks than they were when quarterly reporting requirements were originally established decades ago. In many organizations, the issue is not necessarily lack of information, but fragmented information and difficulty connecting operational developments back to enterprise strategy, risk oversight, and measurable value creation.

For that reason, I believe optional semiannual reporting should be limited to issuers that demonstrate sustained governance and reporting maturity. Reporting flexibility should be earned through demonstrated controls discipline, transparency, and governance reliability.

Potential eligibility criteria could include objective governance and reporting indicators such as:

- no material weaknesses in internal control over financial reporting for a specified multi-year period
- no significant financial restatements within a specified multi-year period
- consistent timely SEC filing history
- independent Audit Committee oversight, including designated financial expertise consistent with existing SEC requirements
- absence of recurring significant deficiencies or disclosure-related enforcement matters

In my view, companies with established governance maturity and strong controls environments may be better positioned to operate effectively with less frequent interim reporting while still maintaining investor confidence and transparency. Conversely, companies with weaker controls environments or recurring deficiencies may benefit from maintaining the discipline and accountability created through quarterly reporting cycles.

I also believe the Commission should carefully consider potential unintended consequences related to:

- reduced comparability between issuers
- varying voluntary disclosure practices
- impacts on smaller investors who rely more heavily on standardized SEC reporting
- potential increases in information asymmetry
- implications for internal controls and disclosure governance processes

In practice, many larger or more mature issuers may continue quarterly reporting due to investor expectations, debt covenants, analyst coverage, or market discipline. However, providing conditional optionality may particularly benefit issuers with demonstrated governance maturity and stable reporting environments.

Finally, I would encourage the Commission to continue emphasizing that governance quality, operational accountability, and long-term value creation are not solely functions of reporting frequency. Strong boards and management teams should remain focused on transparency, risk oversight, capital allocation discipline, and sustainable enterprise performance regardless of whether interim reporting occurs quarterly or semiannually.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on the proposal.

Respectfully submitted,

Colleen Wold